

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 6 2

♥ J 9 5

♦ Q J 6 2

♣ 10 7

♠ 8 7 3

♥ A K 2

♦ K 8 3

♣ A J 5 2



♠ A J 4

♥ Q 10 7 3

♦ 10 9 4

♣ 9 4 3

♠ Q 10 5

♥ 8 6 4

♦ A 7 5

♣ K Q 8 6

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Having won the first ♥ trick in your hand, play a small ♠ and finesse the ♠10. Suppose West wins the ♠K and returns a ♥. Take your ♥A and play another ♠, going up with the ♠Q if East plays low. If the ♠Q wins, take your 9 tricks and run.

Although this doesn't look like a normal A Q finesse it really is about the same.

Whenever the ♠A and ♠K are in different hands, the only thing that matters is the location of the ♠J.

So it is basically a 50% chance.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥3.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=2 ♣=4 Total = 8

First things first. Win the first ♥, do not hold up. East's ♥3 indicates he has led a 4-card suit so a hold-up wouldn't help you. And if you did hold up they might pocket their ♥ trick and switch to ♦s, a suit you are no better off in.

You need to get one more winner and it will have to be a ♠ winner. You could lead toward the ♠Q, winning a trick if East holds BOTH the ♠A and ♠K. Or you could finesse the ♠10, gaining a trick if East holds the ♠J. Obviously the second choice is more likely.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ A 6 5

♦ 8 6 4

♣ 6 5 3

♠ K 5 4 3

♥ J 9 7 2

♦ A 10 7

♣ 10 7



♠ A J 10 8

♥ K 4

♦ Q 5 3

♣ A K Q J

♠ 7

♥ Q 10 8 3

♦ K J 9 2

♣ 9 8 4 2

West

North

East

South

3 ♣

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

♠, finessing North's ♠K again, then play your ♠A and the rest of your winners.

East is to play 4 ♠. South leads the ♦2. The defenders win 3 ♦ tricks, then play a ♣.

Losers: ♠ = 0 or 1 ♥ = 0 ♦ = 3 ♣ = 0 Total = 3 or 4

Since you have already lost 3 ♦ tricks you cannot also lose a ♠ trick. That means North will have to have the ♠K and it also means that you will have to be careful with your finessing.

In your hand with a ♣ you play over to dummy's ♥A. Now lead the ♠Q from dummy and when North plays low play the ♠J (or 10) from your hand.

The ♠Q held the trick so you are still in dummy. Play the ♠9, and when North doesn't cover, play your ♠8 under it. South shows out on this trick and you are glad you played so carefully. Play one more

If you had played the ♠Q and carelessly followed with the ♠8 on your first finesse you would have gone down. You would have had to win the second finesse in your hand and would have no dummy entry to let you take the third finesse.

True, the chances of North holding 4 ♠s to the King are pretty small, but it costs you nothing to protect yourself against that holding.

And the rewards are great.